

End-of-Lease Bond-Back Checklist — ACT

Protect your money — most bond disputes are avoidable with the right documentation.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Understand How Your Bond Works

- ☐ [] **Know your bond is lodged with the ACT Revenue Office**, not held by your landlord or agent directly — lessors must lodge within 2 weeks of receiving it, agents within 4 weeks.
- ☐ [] **Know the maximum bond is 4 weeks' rent**.
- ☐ [] **Understand bond is not a general maintenance fund** — it can only be claimed against for unpaid rent, cleaning to restore the property (allowing for fair wear and tear), or damage beyond fair wear and tear.

Section 2 — Before You Move Out

- ☐ [] **Locate your original entry condition report** — your baseline for comparison.
- ☐ [] **Compare the property's current condition against that report**, room by room.
- ☐ [] **Clean thoroughly**, addressing anything genuinely beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Check every item on the original inventory** is present and in working order.
- ☐ [] **Settle any outstanding rent** before vacating.

Section 3 — At the Final Inspection

- ☐ [] **Attend the final inspection if you can**, comparing the property against the original condition report.
- ☐ [] **Take your own timestamped photos** of every room after cleaning, regardless of whether the agent attends.
- ☐ [] **Keep every receipt** — cleaning, repairs, pest control — as evidence.

Section 4 — Claiming Your Bond

- ☐ [] **Use the Rental Bond Refund form** if all parties agree — the ACT Revenue Office can then release the bond according to the agreed split.
- ☐ [] **If there's a dispute**, either party can apply to the **ACT Civil and Administrative Tribunal (ACAT)** for resolution.
- ☐ [] **Know ACAT can order the bond released in whole or part** to one or more parties after hearing evidence from both sides.

Section 5 — If There's a Dispute

- ☐ [] **Gather your evidence before applying to ACAT**: entry and exit condition reports, timestamped photos, receipts, and correspondence with your landlord/agent.
- ☐ [] **Apply promptly and include your evidence with your application** — ACAT sets specific time limits and application steps, so don't delay once a dispute is clear.
- ☐ [] **Bring copies of any bond forms you or the landlord have signed**, and note the dates you submitted anything relevant.

Quick Reference — ACT Bond Process

ITEM	DETAIL
Bond holder	ACT Revenue Office
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent
Lodgement deadline	2 weeks (lessor) / 4 weeks (agent)
Dispute resolution	ACAT (ACT Civil and Administrative Tribunal)
Fair wear and tear	Cannot be charged against your bond

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